Bentonville Schools AI Guide: Data and Student Privacy Passages

Excerpted verbatim from *Bentonville Schools AI Guide (Bentonville Schools, Arkansas; board policies 4.64, 3.58 and 8.49 adopted 11/18/25)*. Page numbers refer to the PDF pages of the source file. Page numbers are PDF page numbers because the guide has no printed page numbers. Ellipses (…) mark omitted text.

Introduction (excerpt)

Source: page 1

… addressing key considerations such as data privacy, equity, and ethical use.

Privacy, Security, and Confidentiality

Source: page 5

When using GenAI tools, it is crucial to understand that any information provided whether through prompts entered by the user or AI-generated responses could potentially be used by companies to train their models. This includes personal details of students, families, employees, and any proprietary or confidential information belonging to Bentonville Schools. Assume that all information shared with a GenAI application will be used to train the model and could become accessible in the public domain. To safeguard privacy and maintain confidentiality, you should:

- Never input personally identifiable information or protected health information into GenAI tools.
- Never input confidential, sensitive or legally protected information into GenAI tools. Legally protected information would include, though is not limited to, information contained in a student's record; information that identifies students, employees, and other individuals; information contained in an employee's record; proprietary information; etc.
- Never input copyrighted material or proprietary Bentonville Schools intellectual property into GenAI tools.

Approved AI Tools

Source: page 5

Approved AI tools can be found in our Ed Tech Catalog.

Access to GenAI tools is governed by all relevant federal, state, and local laws (FERPA, COPPA, CIPA, etc.), along with District policy. At Bentonville Schools all technology tools, including those that leverage AI, are reviewed, approved, and listed in the BPS Ed Tech Catalog.

Guidance for Students: 4.64 Student Use of Artificial Intelligence

Source: pages 6–7

All AI tools selected by the committee shall comply with applicable state and federal data privacy laws. Students may only use AI tools in the classroom when specifically authorized by their teacher. When students use their District user accounts, they are strictly limited to District-approved, vetted tools to maintain legal compliance and student safety.

As part of using AI tools responsibly, students should be cautious about the information they provide to AI tools and consult with a teacher if unsure. At no time shall Students share personal, sensitive, or confidential information with AI tools, especially AI tools requiring data input. Students are prohibited from using any AI tools that collect and employ user data to train or improve their underlying models. The training of learning models is strictly limited to a classroom setting when it is part of the curriculum instruction on model training, and the model must be managed by the teacher (not utilizing external public data or services).

The following actions regarding AI tools are strictly prohibited:

- Altering or falsifying academic documents or records using AI tools;
- Using AI tools to: Gain unauthorized access to District systems; or Bypass District security measures;

Students should report any inappropriate content or security concerns encountered while using AI tools to a teacher or administrator.

Cross References: 4.13—PRIVACY OF STUDENTS' RECORDS/ DIRECTORY INFORMATION

Guidance for Licensed Personnel: 3.58 Licensed Personnel Use of Artificial Intelligence

Source: pages 8–9

- Only AI tools that have been thoroughly vetted and officially approved via the district's application approval request ticket process are authorized for use. To submit a new tool for approval, please open a Helpdesk ticket at helpdesk.bentonvillek12.org;
- The use of AI tools by licensed employees shall adhere to District policy; State and Federal law; State rules; and federal regulations governing data privacy; and

While AI tools may be used to assist with administrative tasks, such as lesson planning, scheduling, data analysis, and managing student records, final decisions impacting students or employees must involve human oversight.

Employees are responsible for their use of AI tools and for safeguarding sensitive information. Employees shall report any security incidents or potential data breaches immediately to a supervisor or the IT department.

The failure to comply with this policy or a District policy governing the release of information may result in disciplinary action, up to and including termination.

Guidance for Classified Personnel: 8.49 Classified Personnel Use of Artificial Intelligence

Source: pages 10–11

The District will provide training on the use of AI tools, including data privacy requirements. All classified employees shall participate in the District's training on AI tools before they may use AI tools to assist with any job duties. Classified employees shall participate in additional training sessions and are expected to stay informed about changes to this and related policies regarding the use of AI and data privacy and security.

- Only AI tools that have been thoroughly vetted and officially approved via the district's application approval request ticket process are authorized for use. To submit a new tool for approval, please open a Helpdesk ticket at helpdesk.bentonvillek12.org;
- The use of AI tools by employees shall adhere to District policy; State and Federal law; State rules; and federal regulations governing data privacy; and

Any use of AI tools shall be done in an ethical and responsible manner that protects other employees, students, parents, and the District as a whole.

The following actions are expressly prohibited:

- The inputting or uploading of information into AI tools unless the AI tool has been approved by the District to accept such information and appropriate data privacy measures are in place to comply with the District's policies; State and Federal laws; State Rules; and federal regulations on data privacy and security;
- Attempting to bypass security protocols or access restricted data.

Employees are responsible for their use of AI tools and for safeguarding sensitive information. Employees shall report any security incidents or potential data breaches immediately to a supervisor or the IT department.

The failure to comply with this policy or a District policy governing the release of information may result in disciplinary action, up to and including termination.

Cross References: 4.13—PRIVACY OF STUDENTS' RECORDS/ DIRECTORY INFORMATION